

to settle personal scores will have to watch it—and it's not just because of the twisticuffs between Tharoor and Modi. As cyber lawyer Pavan Duggal said, via tweet, "The amended Indian cyber law now makes defamatory tweeting an offence, punishable with three years imprisonment and fine. So the moment you tweet in India, just remember that your tweet brings you within the ambit of the Indian cyber law. Your tweet is data and information in the electronic form and has been granted legal sanction and validity."

Twitter also has other uses suited to a person's need. You can use it as a tool to make friends just like any other social networking site. It can also be an online notebook. You can also use it to get feedback when you need a third party perspective. Even though we know showing-off is not a nice thing, but if you've got it, you flaunt it in twitterworld. It might be your brand new car or your super toned body. Propaganda always goes a long way. Post links to your blogs and websites. A little bit of self-promotion never hurt anyone. Ask Shahid Kapoor who is twittering just for this purpose. It's also a great place to tease or demand twexplanations from celebrities to non-entities. If it does not suit your style, you can simply use it to read news by subscribing to twitter feeds for specific newspapers and magazines.

Twitter is like your neighbourhood café. You don't want to be friends with everyone. But you certainly want to be the first to know that Karan Johar was pushing himself to go to the gym at 10:30 a.m. Or that Sonam Kapoor has started re-reading *Wuthering Heights*. Its simplicity is what makes twitter so successful. It merges a number of trends in social software usage—blogging, presence indicators and IM status messages into a blend of public, private and participatory. It's empowering and liberating. There was a time when talking to one's favourite celebrity could be a life-long dream, but twitter is a

twiscoveries

Everything you didn't want to know about the twitterati but were forced to find out...



Preity Zinta loves children but only if they know how to behave themselves.

Sania Mirza's favourite cricketer is Sachin Tendulkar and not husband Shoaib Malik.

That Mallika Sherawat's behind is "1 of a kind".

Salman Khan loves coffee.

When in Mumbai, Shilpa Shetty walks to the Siddhivinayak Temple every Tuesday.

Chetan Bhagat is smitten by the i-pad ever since he touched one owned by Mandira Bedi.

Imran Khan lost his eyelashes while running atop a burning train for the climax of *Luck*.

Shah Rukh Khan has four dogs, Dash, Hulk, Kai and Juicy.

Boman Irani's son wants Boman to buy a second-hand Nano for himself and get him a Ferrari 599.

Mamma's boy Yuvraj Singh loves to ride bikes but his mum doesn't let him ride one.

with 55,982 followers, who tweets minute by minute updates on his life via twitter, whether he's travelling for the first time on a Shatabdi or writing an article. Plain bored? Take pictures of your surroundings, among them a rock, and upload them in between takes like Salman Khan, who has 59,838 followers.

On an average day, 55 million tweets are posted across the web. The number has gone up from 5,000 a day in 2007 to 30,000 in 2008 to 2.5 million per day last year. There is also room for advertising on twitter now with promoted tweets which companies and advertisers might want to highlight some popular ones to a wider group of users, though co-founder Biz Stone says they would not be traditional adverts. Tweets grew by 1,400 per cent last year to reach 35 million per day. Today, we are seeing 50 million tweets per day—that's an average of 600 tweets per second. And if 60 per cent of registered accounts are from outside the US, many well be from India, where

TWITTER IS A DREAMCATCHER, ESPECIALLY FOR AN ATTENTION-ADDLED GENERATION. IT'S THE ULTIMATE GROUP HUG FOR WANNABES AND WOULD-HAVE-BEENS.

dreamcatcher, much more than a blog, especially for an attention-addled generation. It's the ultimate group hug for wannabes and would-have-beens. Need another perspective? Try tweeting like Arjun Rampal, with 39,999 followers, has been asking people to give suggestions for a new name for his movie *Stepmom*. Just need to share information? Try tweeting like self-proclaimed commentator Kiruba Shankar,

sign-ups have risen 100 per cent since the beginning of the year, thanks to free celebrity endorsements. As Dina Mehta, head of qualitative research at research firm Mosoci, says, "Indian celebrity tweeters have been amplified by the mainstream media big time."

Indeed, it's called twerrific twaffic.

with Nandini Vaish, Sumaiya Khan and Kruttika Rao